



Gaming laptops are designed with hardware and features specifically aimed at enhancing your gaming experience, such as robust GPUs and processors, high-refresh-rate displays, sufficient RAM and storage, and more. However, these features come at a higher premium, so as your budget decreases, certain compromises become necessary. Over the years, the need for compromises has been gradually diminishing in the `60K to `80K price range. This year, the competition was less intense compared to last year, with many brands introducing pricier laptop offerings and lineups. Our Zero1 Award Winner actually belongs to one of these new lineups and secured a landslide victory over the competition. However, our runner-up provided better value-for-money, earning itself both the second spot and the Digit Best Buy Award.

Zero1 Award Winner: **LENOVO LOQ 15APH8**

Lenovo are clearly doing something right in the budget segment as this marks the second time in a row they're taking home the Digit Zero1 Award for this category. The new Lenovo LOQ lineup features more powerful hardware in the familiar

Gaming Laptop (60K - 80K)

For the budding gamer



LENOVO LOQ 15APH8
Price: ₹79,990

DIGIT BEST BUY WINNER-2023



Acer Nitro 5 AN515-58
Price: ₹64,999

IdeaPad Gaming 3 package. While it looks the same on the surface, there has definitely been an improvement in performance. This was one of the few laptops that were nominated to feature an AMD processor in the AMD Ryzen 7 7840HS and the processor was definitely carrying its weight, acing every single processor and productivity benchmark in the category. Of course, this translated to gaming performance as well. Both the winner and runner-up featured RTX 3050 GPUs at the same TGP. The defining factor was the difference in processors and the higher RAM on the Lenovo LOQ. The LOQ had a clean sweep in both synthetic and real-world gaming benchmarks, with the highest scores across the board. The LOQ also featured the fastest RAM of the lot. All of these factors combined made for an easy win for the Lenovo LOQ, which is our deserved Zero1 Award Winner for the Best Performing Gaming Laptop (60K - 80K) category.

Runner-up and Best Buy: **Acer Nitro 5 AN515-58**

The Nitro 5 series has been a long running line-up of budget gaming laptops from Acer and it's still going strong. Like the LOQ, the Nitro 5 also featured an NVIDIA RTX 3050 GPU with a TGP of 95W. While it didn't outperform the LOQ, the gaming numbers were still good, especially if you consider the price point at just `64,999. The laptop also only came with 8GB of RAM, which fortunately is expandable. But we do consider 8GB of RAM to be on the lower side as far as gaming is concerned. Had the laptop come with 16GB of RAM, it might have been able to compete with the LOQ more convincingly. Other than that, the laptop came with a 12th gen Intel Core i5-12450H, which is a whole generation older than the processor on the LOQ and much weaker in comparison. We don't normally see current gen processors in the budget segment so the LOQ really pulled a fast one over the competition here. Despite all of this, the Nitro 5 still gave us great FHD (1080p) scores across the board when it came to gaming, and did especially well in the thermals and throttling department, something the LOQ struggled with. Considering all of the above and the extremely budget price point, the Acer Nitro 5 takes away the deserved Best Buy Award in this category.

— Manish Rajesh | manish@digit.in